

The Lost Lantern Festival

The Floating Isles are islands adrift in a calm sky, in a realm where magic only ever helps: it grows, it heals, it changes one thing into another, and it lets you speak with animals and objects. It never harms. On the home island, the House of the Little Mages sits at the highest point, where young mages learn their first spells, and the city where the families live spreads below. Inside the school grounds lies the Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island. Here nobody loses; you find your way by being clever and kind.



The Lost Lantern Festival

Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only new ideas to try.

Before you begin

Tonight is the Festival of Lights. Every year the families of the Floating Isles send glowing sky lanterns up into the calm evening sky. But when you look out from the House of the Little Mages, the sky is dark. Lantern Square is grey and quiet. The lanterns have floated away.

You are little mages. You pick up your bag. You look at each other. "Let us bring the lights back," you say together. The path to the square is waiting.

What is your mage name? Which magic do you choose: Light, Grow, Change, or Voice?

Stop 1: The Dim Square

You come to Lantern Square. It should be bright and full of song. Instead it is dark. One last sky lantern sits on a stone, but its little flame has gone out.

A soft grey cat steps out of the mist. It is the Mist Cat. It looks at the cold lantern, then up at the sky, where a faint trail of light leads toward the clouds.

How do you light the lantern again? And how could you find out where the others have gone? Try something and see.

When the lantern glows once more, it lifts gently into the air and floats up the trail, as if to show you the way. Up toward the clouds you go.

Stop 2: The Cloud Bank

At the edge of the island you reach a low bank of soft clouds. Some of the clouds feel warm, and if you look closely, they glow a little from inside. The lost lanterns are hiding in there.

A bright Messenger Butterfly flutters down to help.

Which clouds are hiding lanterns? How can you tell, and how do you reach them up there? Try something and see.

When you gather the glowing lanterns out of the clouds, they bob around you in a happy little cloud of light. Only the biggest lantern of all is still missing.

Stop 3: The High Ledge

You look up. High above the square, the biggest festival lantern has drifted against a rocky ledge and caught there. It is too high to reach, and you want to bring it down gently, with no one in any danger.

The evening breeze curls softly around it.

How do you bring the big lantern down safely? Could you grow something soft below? Could you ask the breeze for a gentle nudge? Try something and see.

When the big lantern floats safely down into your hands, the whole square seems to hold its breath. There is just one thing left to understand: where did all the lights go in the first place?

Nimbo the Cloud-Whale Calf

Up among the clouds you find a small, shy cloud-whale calf. Its name is Nimbo. Inside its soft cloudy body, a warm light is glowing. It was Nimbo who gathered the lanterns. Not to spoil the festival. Nimbo was lonely up in the empty sky, and it loved the warm little lights so much that it wanted to keep them close.

There is no fight here. There never was a real villain.

What do you say to Nimbo? How can you show it that it is not alone, and that it can come to the festival too?

When you offer Nimbo your friendship, it gives a happy little rumble and lets the gathered light go. All at once the sky lanterns rise together, the whole evening fills with warm golden light, and Nimbo glows brightest of all as it floats down to join the festival. The Festival of Lights has begun.

You did it together. You were clever, and you were kind. Well done.

The Story in Pictures



A dim festival square with one unlit lantern, the Mist Cat beside it, and a faint trail of light leading up to the clouds.



A low cloud bank where a few clouds glow warmly from hidden lanterns, a Messenger Butterfly nearby and a vine growing up to reach them.



The biggest lantern resting against a high rocky ledge, a soft breeze around it and a vine with a cushion of leaves grown up below.



A shy cloud-whale calf glowing with gathered light as two little mages offer friendship and the freed lanterns rise into a golden sky.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

Content licence: CC BY-SA 4.0 (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>)

Version 7, updated 2026-06-03, en-GB



Scan for the latest version

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.